Limestone topography of Western Slovenia extends for a distance of 480 km in length and 80 km in width which is termed as Karst in the Slavic language. The world's largest karst area is the Nullarbar located on the Great Australian Coast.

Karst regions are also found in Southern France, Spain, Mexico, Jamaica, Western Cuba, Central New Guinea, Sri Lanka and Myanmar.

Karst Areas in India

Western Bihar	-	Guptadham caves
Uttarakhand	-	Robert cave and Tapkeshwar temple
Madhya Pradesh	-	Pandav caves Pachmari hills
Bastar district in Chattisgarh	-	Kutumsar
Andhra Pradesh (Visakhapatnam)	-	Borra caves

Erosional Landforms of Underground Water

Most of erosion takes place due to the process of solution. When rain water mixes with carbon-di- oxide and enters into a limestone region, it dissolves and destroys much of the limestone. As a result, landforms such as **Terra rossa, Lappies, sinkholes, swallow holes, dolines, uvalas, poljes, caves and caverns are formed**.

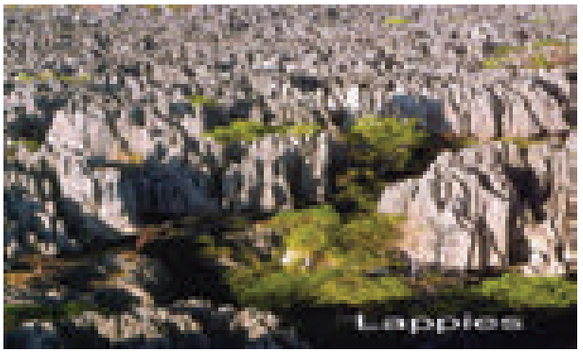
Terra Rossa (Italian term for Red soil)

Deposition of red clay soil on the surface of the Earth is due to the dissolution of limestone content in rocks. The redness of the soil is due to the presence of iron oxide.



Lappies

When the joints of limestone rocks are corrugated by groundwater, long furrows are formed and these are called LAPPIES.



Sinkhole

A funnel shaped depressions formed due to dissolution of limestone rock is called sinkholes. Their average depth ranges between three and nine meters





The World's deepest sinkhole is China's xianozhai Tienkang at 2172 feet. There are as many as 15000 Sinkholes in Illinois

Activity

Take a trough filled with sand. empty a portion of sand in the middle and fill it with sugar. Now level the sand over the sugar. Pour water into the trough and observe what happens. The sugar dissolves and forms a depression. This is similar to the formation of sinkhole.

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